Detroit-Style Pizza

Main dishes | Oven

Before you start

Makes three 10x14-inch pizzas. Give the dough 1-2 days to cold-ferment in the pans, then finish each pizza with a five-minute par-bake and a short final bake.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Flour and salt

Bowl B - Warm water and yeast

Bowl C - Kenji's sauce ingredients

Dough

- [ ] 1050 g bread flour [Bowl A]

- [ ] 30 g kosher salt [Bowl A]
- [ ] 765 g water, warmed to 85-95F [Bowl B]
- [ ] 10.5 g instant dried yeast [Bowl B]

For the pans and topping

- [ ] Butter or shortening, to grease three 10x14-inch pans
- [ ] 48 oz cheese total (16 oz per pizza): brick cheese preferred; white cheddar, Jack, or Havarti also work; mozzarella optional
- [ ] Fresh basil, chopped
- [ ] Pepperoni or other toppings (optional)

Kenji's sauce

- [ ] 2 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil [Bowl C]
- [ ] 3 medium garlic cloves, minced [Bowl C]
- [ ] 2 tsp dried oregano [Bowl C]

- [ ] Dash red pepper flakes [Bowl C]
- [ ] 1 28-oz can high-quality crushed tomatoes [Bowl C]
- [ ] 1 tsp granulated garlic powder [Bowl C]
- [ ] 1 tsp granulated onion powder [Bowl C]
- [ ] 1 tbsp sugar [Bowl C]
- [ ] Kosher salt, to taste [Bowl C]

1. Mix and start the dough

1. Combine the flour and salt in the bowl of a stand mixer fitted with a dough hook.

2. Stir the yeast into the warm water and let it sit 5 minutes. Slowly add the water mixture while mixing on low, about 10 minutes, until the dough is smooth, very wet, and sticky. Scrape the bowl as needed.

3. With wet hands, fold the dough into a ball. Cover and leave at room temperature 1-2 hours to begin fermentation; it should rise somewhat but does not need to double.

2. Pan and cold-ferment

1. Divide the rested dough into 3 equal balls. Grease three 10x14-inch Detroit-style pans with butter or shortening.

2. Place one dough ball in each pan. With wet hands, flatten and stretch it as close to the edges as possible. Cover the pans and refrigerate 1-2 days.

3. Prepare for baking

1. Bring the pans to room temperature for 3 hours. Preheat a home oven to 550F. For an outdoor pizza oven, preheat to 700-800F for about 20 minutes.

2. Let each dough rest in its pan 30 minutes, then stretch again so it reaches every edge. Par-bake each pizza on the bottom of a home oven for 5 minutes.

4. Make Kenji's sauce

1. Warm the olive oil in a saucepan. Add the garlic, oregano, and red pepper flakes; cook just until fragrant.

2. Stir in the tomatoes, garlic powder, onion powder, sugar, and salt. Simmer until slightly thickened, then cool enough to spoon over the pizzas. The sauce can be made ahead and refrigerated.

5. Top, bake, and serve

1. Carefully remove a hot pan. Add mozzarella first if using, then scatter cubed or shredded brick cheese all the way to the edges. Spoon sauce in wide stripes and add pepperoni or other toppings.

2. For a home oven, return the pizza to the bottom rack for about 7 minutes. Broil for the last 1-2 minutes only if the cheese or pepperoni needs more browning. For an outdoor pizza oven, bake 5-6 minutes, rotate halfway through, and cover with foil if it browns too quickly.

3. Run a thin metal spatula around the edges, slide the pizza onto a wire rack, rest 3 minutes, finish with basil, and slice.

Notes

This preserves the saved personal pan-first workflow: divide into three dough balls and spread into pans before the 1-2 day cold ferment.

The original Pala Pizza method uses the same dough formula for one 10x14-inch pizza; the saved document scales it to three pans. The par-bake-and-freeze question in the source document remains an experiment, not an adopted step.